

FAQs

Unable to search in Windows XP

Q. I have a Celeron 1 GHz with an Intel 810-based motherboard and a 40 GB hard drive running Windows XP and Windows Me. When I run the Search function from Windows XP, it gives an error saying, 'A file that is required to run Search Companion cannot be found. You may need to run setup.' The search window appears, but there are no fields in the pane on the left. When I click on the character, it keeps repeating the same action—even right-clicking on it has no effect. Please help me.

Chandru

Via e-mail

A This is a documented error that happens with some installations of Windows XP—download the patch for it from <http://www.microsoft.com/Downloads/Release.aspx?ReleaseID=39318>. After downloading, follow the on-screen instructions.

Flickering screen and low virtual memory

Q. I have a Pentium 4 1.6 GHz processor, Intel 850 MV motherboard with 128 MB RDRAM and a 17-inch monitor that flickers around the edges. Also, very light curves appear on the display when I set no wallpaper. I normally work in Windows XP. What can I do to solve this problem? Another problem is that after playing *Duke Nukem*, when I exit, sometimes an icon appears in the system tray showing the message, 'Your system is low on virtual memory.' I had the same problem with Real Player until I uninstalled it. What can I do to solve this problem?

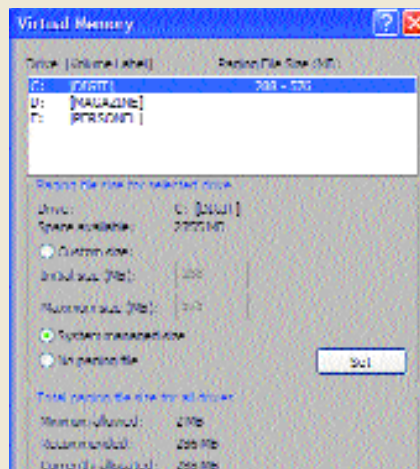
Yash

Via e-mail

A To solve your first problem go to **Desktop > Properties > Settings > Advanced**. Go to the Monitor tab and set the Refresh Rate to 75 Hz or more. You could set a higher refresh rate but make sure your monitor supports it.

Your second problem lies with the operating system's virtual memory settings. A permanent solution would be to upgrade your memory to 256 MB. Another solution would be to go to **Control Panel > System > Advanced > Performance** and click on Settings. Click Advanced in the new window and go to Change. Here set you

virtual memory management to 'System managed size'—if this option was already chosen, then it means that you're low on hard disk space. You'll need to restart your



'System managed size' suits most users

computer for the changes to take effect. Note the drive in which the swap file resides and free up at least 250 MB in that drive by deleting unnecessary files.

Restoring file associations

Q. My PC has MS Office, therefore MS Photo Editor is installed with it. Hence, I cannot open JPG and GIF files in Internet Explorer. How do I uninstall it?

Samar

Via e-mail

A Rather than uninstalling Photo Editor, which is rather an awkward process requiring you to re-run the Office installation, you can restore file associations back to Internet Explorer. To do this, locate the JPG or GIF file you want to open. Click on it to select the file and then, while pressing [Shift], right-click on it. In the popup menu, choose 'Open with...' You will then be presented with a list of applications that can be used to open the file. Scroll down until you see the entry 'iexplore'. Select it and make sure that the checkbox titled 'Always use this program to open this type of file' is checked. Click OK and the setting will be finalised. Repeat this procedure for all the other file types that you wish to open with Internet Explorer. The procedure is approximately the same with all versions of Windows.

I use Norton AntiVirus 2000 for protection. I update the virus definitions every month and as a result, I have updated 13 times in the last 13 months. Recently, I upgraded my hard drive from 20 GB to 40 GB. So now I have to transfer all my data to this drive and install a clean copy of Windows 98. How do I back up my virus definitions so that I don't have to update them again?

Namrata

Via e-mail

A Updates of Norton AntiVirus include virus definition updates as well as updates to the scanning engine. Although you won't be able to carry over your engine upgrades, transferring the virus definitions is a simple task. You can find these definitions in the C:\Program Files\Common Files\Symantec Shared\VirusDefs folder. Just copy this folder and paste it in the same location in the new installation.

Compatible AGP slot

Q. I recently bought an MSI 845E MAX2-BLR MS-6398E motherboard. I intend to buy a GeForce4 graphics card. In the motherboard manual, it says 'AGP 4x slot (1.5V only)'. Will I be able to use the GeForce4 GPU on my motherboard? Is there any way I can increase the 4x to anything higher for future use? How long can I use 4x to play the latest games?

Leejo

Via e-mail

A To answer your second question first, you cannot upgrade your AGP slot's capabilities as this will involve changes in the circuit and power requirements. However, you have no cause for concern as your motherboard will support even ATI's Radeon 9700 and other new graphics cards. Regarding the relevance of 4x, as the latest cards have just begun to support the 8x mode, rest assured that you can use your board for quite some time to come. Your 4x AGP interface has enough bandwidth to run the present crop of games, giving you no reason to fret for a while.



Send your computing problems to
sos@jasubhai.com
or write to Digit,

D-222/2, Om Sagar, MIDC, Nerul-400 706, and we may answer it here!